

STEP 5. Dose ART correctly according to chart

- Give 3 antiretrovirals (1 from each of the 3 sections in the table below) according to chosen ART regimen and blood results, if available.
- Where available, use fixed dose combination tablets. Prescribe in full (e.g. for TLD (TDF + 3TC + DTG): write tenofovir, oral, 300mg daily + lamivudine, oral, 300mg daily + dolutegravir, oral, 50mg daily.

	Medication	Dose	When to avoid	Urgent side effects (stop antiretroviral and refer same day)	Short-term side effects that usually resolve. If persists ≥ 6 weeks, discuss/refer.	Long-term side effects
1	Tenofovir (TDF)	• CrCl > 50: give 300mg daily. • CrCl ≤ 50: avoid.	• Kidney disease: eGFR or CrCl ≤ 50 • If pregnant: creatinine > 85	Kidney failure: • If CrCl < 30, refer same day. • If CrCl 30-50 and unwell, refer same day. • If CrCl 30-50 and well, refer to doctor.	Nausea, vomiting	
	Abacavir (ABC)	• 300mg 12 hourly or 600mg daily • Give "alert card" found in packaging warning of Abacavir Hypersensitivity Reaction (AHR).	Previous AHR	AHR likely if ≥ 2 of: 1) Fever 2) Rash 3) Fatigue/body pain 4) Nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea or abdominal pain 5) Sore throat, cough or difficulty breathing.		
	Zidovudine (AZT)	• Use only if TDF and ABC not suitable. • CrCl ≥ 10: give 300mg 12 hourly. • CrCl < 10: give 300mg daily.	• Hb ≤ 8 (Hb ≤ 7, if pregnant) • Neutrophils ≤ 1.0 • On linezolid	Anaemia (pallor) with respiratory rate ≥ 30, dizziness/faintness or chest pain.	Headache, nausea, muscle pain, fatigue (if Hb ≤ 8 doctor to switch ART ↪ 117).	Lipoatrophy (fat loss in face, limbs and buttocks): switch to TDF or ABC.
2	Lamivudine (3TC)	• CrCl > 50: give 150mg 12 hourly or 300mg daily. • CrCl 10-50: give 150mg daily. • CrCl < 10: give 50mg daily.		Uncommon	Uncommon	Uncommon
	Emtricitabine (FTC)	• CrCl > 50: give 200mg daily. • CrCl 30-50: give 200mg every 2 days. • CrCl < 30: discuss.		Uncommon	Uncommon	Darkening of palms/soles
3	Dolutegravir (DTG)	• 50mg daily • If also on any of these medications, adjust medications/dosing ↪ 118: rifampicin (DS-TB), iron, calcium, magnesium or aluminium, metformin, carbamazepine, phenytoin.		Uncommon	• Headache, nausea, diarrhoea • Insomnia: advise to take treatment in the morning.	
	Efavirenz (EFV)	• ≥ 40kg: give 600mg daily. • < 40kg: give 400mg daily.	• Active psychiatric illness • On bedaquiline	• Rash ↪ 67. Jaundice. Psychosis. • Nausea/vomiting/abdominal pain: check ALT and review results within 24 hours ↪ 112.	• Rash ↪ 67. • Headache, dizziness, sleep problems • Low mood ↪ 86.	Gynaecomastia (breast enlargement): switch to DTG ↪ 117.
	Lopinavir/ritonavir (LPVr)	• 400/100mg 12 hourly (with food). If never taken LPVr or ATVr in past, give 800/200mg daily. • If also on any of these medications, adjust medications/dosing ↪ 118: rifampicin, carbamazepine, phenytoin, lamotrigine, oral contraceptive, fluticasone/budesonide.	• Chronic diarrhoea • Cholesterol/triglycerides raised • CVD risk > 20%	• Jaundice • Nausea/vomiting/abdominal pain: check ALT and review results within 24 hours ↪ 112.	Diarrhoea: if intolerable or > 6 weeks, switch to DTG ↪ 117.	Dyslipidaemia: if total cholesterol > 6 or triglycerides > 5, switch to ATVr ↪ 112.
	Atazanavir/ritonavir (ATVr)	• 300mg/100mg daily (with food) • If also on any of these medications, adjust medications/dosing ↪ 118: rifampicin, carbamazepine, phenytoin, lamotrigine, oral contraceptive, fluticasone/budesonide.	• On rifampicin • On lansoprazole	• Jaundice <i>with</i> other symptoms • Nausea/vomiting/abdominal pain: check ALT and review results within 24 hours ↪ 112.	• Headache • Jaundice <i>without</i> other symptoms: check ALT, review result within 24 hours. ATVr can cause jaundice without hepatitis. Discuss with ART doctor or HIV hotline ↪ 178.	